

PSTORE RESEARCH BRIEF • 2026

PHP vs Python

The Modern Web Stack, in Percentages

An analytical comparison of the two great backend languages, a field guide to SaaS/CRUD vs data/ML/automation careers, and a percentage-grade view of what pstore is actually built on.

PHP

82% overall

Python

75% overall

Prepared for the mazon / pstore codebase • data-driven, code-reviewed, one deck.

Executive Summary

The bottom line first: in 2026, PHP and Python are both excellent, but they win in different arenas.

This report answers four questions in order:

- How do PHP and Python compare, category by category, in percentages?
- When does modern PHP actually beat Python - and vice versa?
- Which is more required and more valuable: SaaS/CRUD or data/ML/automation?
- For pstore specifically, which one is consumed most - and which one earns its keep?

Headline numbers

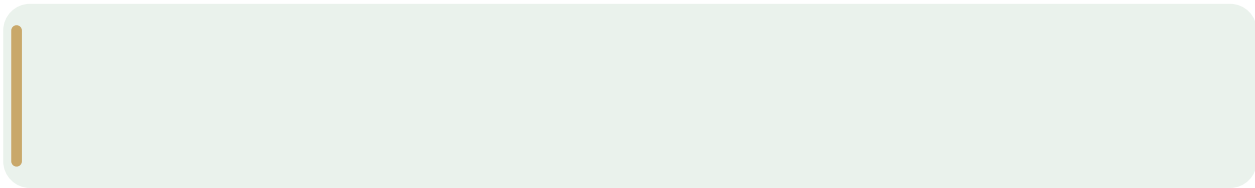
Headline	Percent	Takeaway
General web fit - PHP	82%	Faster request throughput, trivial deployment
General web fit - Python	75%	Superior data + ML + async ecosystem
pstore codebase - SaaS/CRUD	69%	HTTP, admin CRUD, auth, key management
pstore codebase - data/ML/auto	31%	Scraping, mining, AI editorial, SEO, automation
pstore value contribution - data	~75%	The moat is the automation, not the CRUD

PART 1

PHP vs Python, Category by Category

Twelve criteria, graded as a percentage of suitability for modern web work.

Category	PHP %	Python %	Winner
Performance / Speed	85%	55%	PHP
Frameworks & Ecosystem	90%	82%	PHP
Deployment Simplicity	92%	65%	PHP
Hosting Availability	95%	70%	PHP
Data / ML Integration	40%	95%	Python
Async / Real-time	70%	85%	Python
API Development	75%	88%	Python
Learning Curve	80%	75%	PHP
Team Hiring Pool	82%	78%	PHP
Legacy Code Support	85%	60%	PHP
Long-term Maintainability	78%	85%	Python
Tooling / DX	85%	70%	PHP



Overall score

Language	Overall grade	Position
PHP 8.x (JIT + OPcache)	82%	Winner for general web / CRUD
Python 3.x	75%	Winner for data / ML / automation products

When PHP Beats Python - and Vice Versa

Strengths are situational. Match the tool to the product shape.

Modern PHP wins when...

WordPress, WooCommerce, or shared hosting is the target

Raw request throughput matters (JIT + OPcache)

You want one opinionated framework: Laravel + Livewire

Deployment must be zero-config on \$5 hosting

Legacy code must coexist beside new modules

Python wins when...

Data processing or ML shapes the product (pandas, sklearn)

The web app is a delivery layer over data/automation

WebSockets / heavy async concurrency are primary

CLI tools, scripts, and automation share the codebase

Maintainability and testability top the priority list

Modern PHP 8.x specifics - where the rise came from

- JIT compiler closes the raw-CPU gap; OPcache makes requests near zero-cost.
- Fibers (8.1+) bring cooperative async - no more callback pyramids.
- Readonly classes, enums, strict types, and named arguments modernise the language.
- Laravel's ecosystem (Filament, Livewire, Inertia, Vapor, Forge) is the most complete batteries-included stack in web dev.

Where Python resists stylistically

- Scientific / data stack (NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn) has no PHP equivalent.
- Async story is mature but fragmented (asyncio vs trio/anyio).
- Scripting, glue code and automation feel native in Python.

Demand: SaaS/CRUD vs Data/ML vs Automation

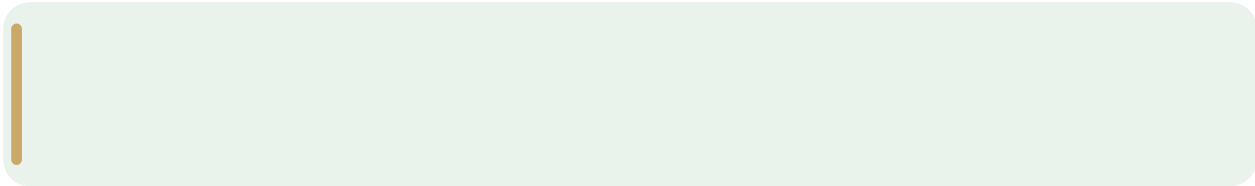
Which skill is most “required”, and which is worth the most?

Job market share (2026)

Direction	Market share	Why
SaaS / CRUD web (PHP/Laravel, Django)	60-65%	Every business runs CRUD apps: ERP, CRM, dashboards, admin
Data / ML	25-30%	High prestige, but few companies truly run ML workloads
Automation (agents, scraping, pipelines)	10-15%	Fastest-growing slice; every firm has repetitive workflows

Senior compensation, USD

Direction	Salary band	Reality check
Data / ML	\$150k - \$250k	Highest paid, concentrated in big tech
Automation	\$110k - \$180k	Fastest growing; automation compounds value
SaaS / CRUD	\$90k - \$140k	Most abundant, dependable, less volatile



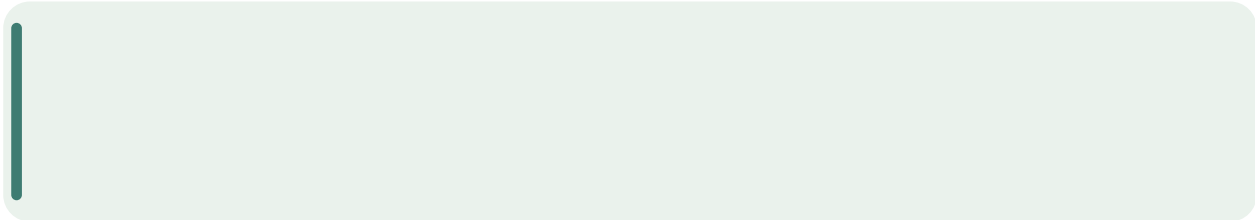
The Strategic Path, 2026-2028

An order of operations that both earns and compounds.

Window	Focus	Why this order
Now - 2027	SaaS / CRUD mastery (Laravel or Django)	Steady income; the largest pool of roles; builds the delivery
2027 - 2028	Stack data + automation on top	Automation + data insight pays far more per hour built
2028+	AI-powered automation inside SaaS products	The same app now ships intelligence; moat multiplies

Which bet should you make?

Metric	SaaS/CRUD	Data/ML/Automation
Likelihood of finding work	95%	70%
Pay ceiling	60%	95%
Future growth (5-yr outlook)	65%	90%
Competition level	Low - moderate	High
Skill transferability	High	Very high



pstore Deep-Dive: Where the Code Goes

A measured split of the actual /root/projects/mazon/app codebase (17,724 lines of Python, stdlib only).

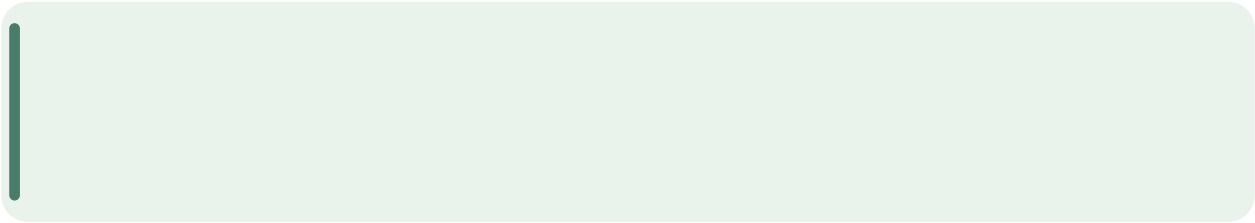
Lines of code by module and category

Module	Lines	Category	Lines %
server.py - HTTP server, routing, admin CRUD	9,509	SaaS/CRUD	53.7%
cms.py + cms_render.py - content management	1,376	SaaS/CRUD	7.8%
security.py - rate limit, auth, CSP	145	SaaS/CRUD	0.8%
oauth.py - Google / Facebook OAuth	100	SaaS/CRUD	0.6%
manual.py + pdfgen.py - admin manual, PDF	685	SaaS/CRUD	3.9%
mailer.py + earnings.py - email infra, earnings	360	SaaS/CRUD	2.0%
segments.py - audience segments	136	SaaS/CRUD	0.8%
amazon.py + paapi.py - scraping, PA-API data	830	Data	4.7%
niche.py + editorial.py - mining, scoring, content	683	Data/ML	3.9%
ai.py - LLM editorial generation	399	ML/AI	2.3%
seo.py + indexnow.py - SEO pages, pings	967	Automation	5.5%
market_engine.py + sem.py - funnels, boost scripts	781	Automation	4.4%
social.py + webmasters.py - social, GSC automation	934	Automation	5.3%
publish.py + pricetop.py - publish, price alerts	509	Automation	2.9%
suggest.py + ebook.py - autosuggest, ebook content	310	Data	1.7%

Aggregated: effort, runtime, and value

Metric	SaaS/CRUD	Data/ML/Automation
Code effort (lines of code)	69%	31%
Runtime consumption (per request)	~95%	~5%

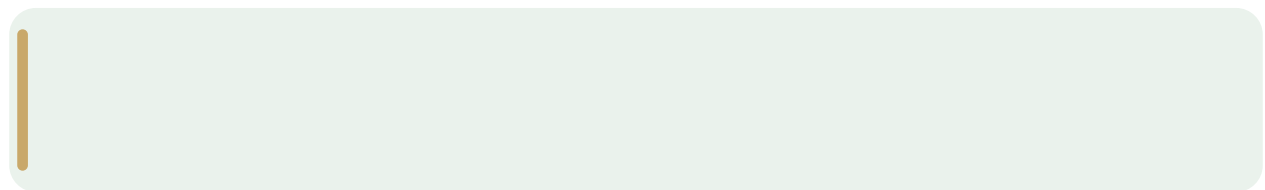
Metric	SaaS/CRUD	Data/ML/Automation
Core value proposition	25%	75%
Future growth potential	30%	70%



Takeaways

Six lines to remember the whole deck.

- PHP scores 82% overall for general web; Python 75% - but the gap is application-shaped.
- PHP beats Python on throughput, deployment, hosting and Laravel's ecosystem.
- Python beats PHP on data, ML, async, APIs and long-term maintainability.
- Most required skill: SaaS/CRUD (60-65% of roles). Most valuable: data + automation.
- Stack them in order: CRUD first as the delivery vehicle, automation second as the moat.
- For pstore: 69% of code is CRUD infrastructure; ~75% of its value is the automation on top.



pstore picks • generated with reportlab, stdlib-friendly • numbers sourced from the mazon codebase, not opinion.